

STEP 02

The Platform

Platform Selection & Targeting Research — Complete with your TRN strategist.

Platform selection is not a preference — it is a data-driven decision based on where your Persona sits in their awareness journey and where they spend time online. This form captures the inputs TRN needs to select, set up, and launch your paid media platform.

Pre-requisite: Step 01 (Persona Formula) must be completed before this form. Your BANT qualification criteria, Persona demographics, and pain-state keywords from Step 01 are the foundation for every platform and targeting decision below.

SECTION A

Your Persona's Awareness Level

The awareness level of your dream client determines which platform we use. Select the level that best describes where most of your ideal clients are RIGHT NOW:

LEVEL	% OF MARKET	WHAT THIS MEANS	PRIMARY PLATFORM	SELECT
Unaware	~50%	Does not know they have the problem yet. Scrolling passively.	Meta / Instagram / TikTok	☐
Consideration	~15%	Aware of the problem, researching solutions but not actively searching.	Google Display / YouTube Retarget	☐
Problem Aware	~35%	Actively searching for a solution RIGHT NOW. High intent, ready to act.	Google Search + YouTube	☐

★ TRN default: We allocate the majority of budget to the Problem Aware segment (Google Search + YouTube) for the lowest cost per lead and highest lead quality.

Additional notes on where your persona spends time online:

e.g. 'Our clients are active on LinkedIn' / 'They watch YouTube tutorials in our niche'

SECTION B

Platform Overview — Where We Can Run

Below is a summary of each platform TRN can activate. Review and confirm which platforms are relevant for your business.

Platform	Best For	Lead Quality	CPL	Budget %
Google Search	Highest-intent leads — persona is actively typing their problem into Google right now.	High	Low	50–60 %
YouTube	Video ads before/during niche content. Builds trust fast. Combines with Google data for precision retargeting.	High	Low–Med	20–30 %
Meta (Facebook/Instagram)	Wide reach for brand awareness and retargeting warm audiences. Lower intent, higher volume.	Medium	Medium	10–20 %
LinkedIn	Best for B2B: target by job title, seniority, company size. Higher CPL but very precise for corporate clients.	High	High	0–15%
Google Display	Banner ads across Google's network — best for retargeting visitors who didn't convert.	Low–Med	Low	5–10%

Tick the platforms to activate for this client:

- ☐ Google Search
- ☐ YouTube
- ☐ Meta (Facebook/Instagram)
- ☐ LinkedIn
- ☐ Google Display
- ☐ TikTok (other)

SECTION C

Budget Allocation

Based on the platforms selected, define the monthly ad spend split. Total budget should equal 100% of the client's agreed monthly ad spend.

Total Monthly Ad Budget (Rands):

e.g. R10 000 / R17 500 / R25 000

Budget Split by Platform:

Fill in the Rand amount and percentage per platform. Total must equal 100%.

PLATFORM	MONTHLY SPEND (R)	% OF BUDGET	ROLE
Google Search			Primary traffic — highest intent leads
YouTube			Trust-building + Google retargeting loop
Meta / Instagram			Awareness + warm retargeting
LinkedIn			B2B precision targeting
Google Display			Retargeting warm non-converters
Other			Specify:
TOTAL			Must equal 100%

SECTION D

Google Search — Keyword & Targeting Brief

Google Search ads target people who are actively typing their problem into Google. The keywords you choose determine who sees your ad — and at what cost. Complete this section to brief the TRN media team.

Primary Keywords (3–5 most important search terms your persona would type):

e.g. 'digital marketing agency johannesburg' / 'how to get more leads for my business'

Secondary / Long-Tail Keywords (more specific, lower volume, lower cost):

e.g. 'lead generation company south africa' / 'google ads management johannesburg'

Negative Keywords (searches you want to EXCLUDE from showing your ad):

e.g. 'free' / 'DIY' / 'jobs' / 'course' / 'how to do it yourself'

Target Location(s)

e.g. Johannesburg, Sandton, Gauteng, National

Target Language

e.g. English only

Bid Strategy

e.g. Maximise Conversions / Target CPA

Daily Budget (approx.)

e.g. R330/day (R10k/mo)

Match Type Preference

e.g. Broad Match / Phrase / Exact

Ad Schedule — when should ads run?

e.g. Mon–Fri 7am–7pm / Always on / Business hours only

Device targeting preference:

☒ All devices (recommended)

☐ Mobile only

☐ Desktop only

☐ Mobile + Desktop (exclude tablet)

SECTION E

YouTube — Targeting Research Sheet

YouTube targeting is powered by Google data — making it the most precise video platform available. We target people watching content directly related to your persona's pain. Complete the table below to build your YouTube targeting brief.

TARGETING TYPE	YOUR INPUTS	RESEARCH SOURCE
Pain-State Keywords	e.g. 'how to generate leads', 'digital marketing agency review' 	Google Keyword Planner
Competitor Names	e.g. [Competitor 1], [Competitor 2], [Competitor 3] 	Manual research
Competitor Websites	e.g. competitor1.co.za, agency2.com 	Google / SimilarWeb
Indirect Websites	e.g. entrepreneur.co.za, bizcommunity.com 	Client + Ahrefs
YouTube Channels	e.g. channels your persona watches — industry, education, news 	YouTube Search
Interest Categories	e.g. Business Services, Marketing, Entrepreneurs 	Google Ads Manager
Custom Intent URLs	Paste 5–10 competitor / industry page URLs 	Manually compiled

SECTION F

Meta / Social — Audience Targeting Brief

Complete this section only if Meta (Facebook/Instagram) or LinkedIn is part of your platform mix. Social ads target audiences by interest and behaviour — not search intent.

Meta Interest Targeting — what interests, pages, or behaviours match your persona?

e.g. 'Small business owners', 'Entrepreneurship', 'Sales and marketing', specific competitor pages

Meta Custom Audience

Upload existing client list? Y / N — List size: ____

Meta Lookalike Source

e.g. Website visitors / Existing customers

LinkedIn Targeting (B2B only) — job titles, seniority, industries, company size:

e.g. 'Marketing Director, CEO, Business Owner / Company size 10–200 / Johannesburg'

SECTION G

Ad Creative Brief

The platform brief is only complete when we know what creative assets are needed. Complete this section so TRN can brief the creative/copy team.

Ad formats needed:

- ☐ Google Search ad (text only)
- ☐ YouTube in-stream video (15–30 sec)
- ☐ YouTube skippable video (30–60 sec)
- ☐ Meta image ad (single)
- ☐ Meta carousel ad
- ☐ Meta video ad
- ☐ LinkedIn text/image ad
- ☐ Display banner set

Core hook / opening line for video ad:

The first 5 seconds must stop the scroll. e.g. 'Are you spending money on ads and getting zero results?'

Primary Call-to-Action (CTA) for all ads:

e.g. 'Book your free audit now' / 'Claim your free strategy session' / 'Get 10 leads in 30 days'

Do you have existing brand assets (logo, brand colours, video footage, testimonials)?

List what is available and any restrictions on use.

Brand Primary Colour (hex or description)

e.g. #C9A84C / Gold

Brand Secondary Colour

e.g. #0D0D0D / Black

SECTION H

Platform Performance Targets

Set your baseline targets for this platform. These feed directly into your Step 06 Optimisation Dashboard and Traffic Light Machine.

METRIC	BASELINE (Month 1)	TARGET (Month 3)	GREEN THRESHOLD
Ad CTR (%)			> 1.5%
Cost Per Click (CPC)			Below baseline
Cost Per Lead (CPL)			< R400

Impressions / Month			100 000+
Leads / Month			25+
Funnel Conversion Rate			> 30%

SECTION I

Sign-Off & Next Steps

Any additional notes for the TRN media team?

Once this brief is approved, TRN will:

- 1. Complete the keyword research and audience build.
- 2. Brief the creative team on ad copy and video script.
- 3. Set up campaign structure in Google Ads / Meta Business Manager / LinkedIn Campaign Manager.
- 4. Connect all platforms to the CRM and UTM tracking system (Step 05).
- 5. Launch and begin collecting Day 1 data for the Optimisation Dashboard (Step 06).

Client Name:

Date:

Platform approved. Next: Step 03 — The Offer.